



**CUDDLES
CHILD MindERS
& SCHOOLS (The Cuddles
Hall)**



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Designed by Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall) for Cuddles Childminders and Schools and The Cuddles Hall.



DEAR PARENT(S),

We warmly welcome you to Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall), where we are deeply committed to the social, mental, spiritual, intellectual, emotional, and physical development of every child entrusted to our care.

We would like to use this medium to acquaint you with our philosophy, policies, procedures, and the services we provide. We believe that a clear understanding of these guidelines will foster a positive and mutually beneficial relationship between the school and our parents.

We kindly ask that you take the time to read this information carefully. Doing so will help prevent misunderstandings, clarify your expectations of us, and ensure that you are fully aware of our expectations of you as a valued member of the Cuddles Childminders and Schools community.

We sincerely appreciate your continued cooperation, partnership, and support.

Thank you for choosing Cuddles Childminders and Schools.

OUR PHILOSOPHY

The philosophy of **Cuddles Childminders and Schools** is based on a set of strongly held beliefs:

Every Child Is Unique We believe that each child is a unique individual. We are sensitive to their social, emotional, spiritual, intellectual, and physical needs . We provide developmentally appropriate programmes that focus on the process of learning and help children enjoy successful experiences. We encourage not only learning but also a love of learning .	Positive Discipline We believe in positive methods of discipline. We establish consistent, age-appropriate limits to help children function confidently in their world. Our programmes are designed to develop in children a sense of independence and responsibility . We desire to strengthen each child's cultural identity while instilling a respect for others who may be different.
A Safe and Stimulating Environment We believe in providing a physical environment that is safe, clean, healthy, and child centred . Classrooms are arranged to offer challenging play and learning choices at a range of developmental levels. Our school provides children with opportunities to explore, experience, and, most importantly, succeed .	. Partnership with Parents We believe that parents are the most significant adults in a child's life. We strive to create mutual respect between parents and teachers and foster a strong partnership for the benefit of each child. We maintain open and consistent communication between parents and school staff. Our doors are always open to parents .
Dedicated and Empowered Staff We believe that the strength of our school lies in the dedication of our teaching and non-teaching staff. We	We Value People Cuddles Childminders and Schools is an organisation that values people—the children in our care, their parents, and

support our teachers through training, resources, and the freedom to create unique learning experiences for children. We provide opportunities for teachers to share ideas and grow professionally. Our teachers create a **caring and nurturing atmosphere** that fosters each child's creativity, confidence, and positive self-image.

our employees. We continually work to earn the trust placed in us. Each day, we strive to be an outstanding provider of **early childhood education and care** in every community we serve.

OUR PRESCHOOL & BASIC ELEMENTARY LEVEL CLASSES POLICY

Thank you for your interest in **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** and our childcare and educational programmes.

We believe that every child is **special and unique**, and it is our goal to provide a safe, nurturing environment that promotes **self-esteem, confidence, security, and holistic development**.

We provide both **formal and informal educational programmes** designed to promote learning through hands-on experiences, play, exploration, and discovery.

We encourage parents to discuss their expectations and aspirations for their child with us. We are always open to feedback regarding our programmes and services. We believe that effective communication and a strong relationship between parents and school are essential and are in the **best interests of everyone, especially the children**.

1.0 ABOUT THE HEAD OF SCHOOL

The Head of School:

- Is a university graduate with a degree in **Industrial Chemistry**.
- Holds several **certified educational diplomas**.
- Is registered with and licensed by the **Teachers Registration Council of Nigeria (TRCN)**.
- Holds several certifications in different aspects of education and is committed to continuous professional development through regular educational training and courses.
- Has training and experience in **environmental health**.
- Is a **British-certified CPR and Paediatric First Aid Provider**.

2.0 REGISTRATION & APPROVALS

- We are registered with the **Federal Government of Nigeria through the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC)** and the **Federal Ministry of Education**.
- Our site of operation is fully approved for use by the **Directorate of Quality Assurance**.
- We hold learning-operation approval covering **preschool through basic education**.
- In accordance with applicable **FCT Social Welfare requirements**, we complete **15 hours of in-house training annually**.

- We are members of the **National Association of Proprietors of Private Schools (NAPPS)** and the **Association of Christian Schools International (ACSI)**.
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3.0 CURRICULUM

The curriculum at CCMS includes both **child-initiated and teacher-directed activities and experiences** that support and enrich children's physical, emotional, social, intellectual, and cognitive development.

Each classroom has **weekly lesson plans** that outline a range of activities designed to foster the development of each child and the group as a whole. Lesson plans are reviewed and modified from time to time to accommodate the children's **changing interests, developmental needs, and learning goals**.

Outdoor Play

Outdoor play is an important part of a child's physical development and is included in the schedule of all classes. Every child is expected to participate in outdoor play except where a medical condition prevents participation.

Where outdoor play is medically inadvisable for a child, a **medical certificate stating the relevant medical condition and providing sufficient details regarding the restriction must be submitted to the school**. Verbal notification alone will not be sufficient.

4.0 SCHOOL PROGRAMME

Our preschool programme is structured around:

- Individual activities
- Group activities
- Supervised free time
- Supervised outdoor play

Many of these activities focus on early learning and life skills, including **letter sounds, numbers, colours, shapes, good manners, dressing independently, personal care, and helping with age-appropriate activities at home**.

4.1 PRESCHOOL PROGRAMME THEMES

Our preschool programme covers the following levels:

Crèche | Playgroup | Reception | Pre-Nursery | Nursery I | Nursery II | Intermediate

Small-Muscle Development

Activities include colouring, tracing, writing, puzzles, playdough, block play, and a variety of other activities designed to develop fine-motor coordination.

Large-Muscle Development

Activities include crawling, marching, running, jumping, dancing, stretching, exercise, and sports participation such as playing catch, football, climbing, and other age-appropriate physical activities.

Creative Play

Creative play stimulates children's imagination and language skills. Play areas may include a shop, post office, market, dress-up area, and puppet theatre.

Arts and Crafts

Children participate in projects that emphasise creativity, technique, experimentation, and self-expression. The focus is on **the process of creating and trying rather than solely on the final outcome.**

Music

Music is incorporated into the daily programme through songs, rhymes, poems, piano, violin, and recorded music.

Me and the World Around Me (Science)

Children participate in activities that encourage investigation, observation, curiosity, and problem-solving. Examples include growing plants, observing insects and butterflies, and exploring the natural environment.

Numeracy (Mathematics)

Counting is incorporated into everyday activities. Children also explore concepts such as **volume, size, shape, measurement, quantity, patterns, and spatial relationships.**

Language Arts (Literacy)

Story time takes place daily. Children are encouraged to participate in group conversations, social conversations, storytelling, role-play, and other language-development activities.

Literacy—the ability to read and write at an age-appropriate level—is a cornerstone of our preschool programme.

Critical Thinking

Children are encouraged to observe differences and similarities, troubleshoot, ask questions, investigate, and develop age-appropriate **problem-solving and critical-thinking skills**.

Outdoor Play

Children go outdoors daily, weather permitting. When weather conditions are unsuitable—for example, when it is excessively hot, cold, or otherwise unsafe—we remain indoors and provide activities that promote **large-muscle development and physical activity**.

Our Approach

We essentially operate a **child-centred curriculum** that focuses on the developmental needs of the early years. We place particular emphasis on establishing strong foundational skills, especially **literacy, numeracy, communication, independence, and social development**, before children progress through the educational stages.

4.2 BASIC ELEMENTARY LEVEL PROGRAMME

The **Basic Elementary Level (BEL 1–BEL 6)** is a six-year programme designed to build a strong academic, social, emotional, and practical foundation for each child's educational journey.

Throughout the Basic Elementary Level programme, learners encounter and develop knowledge and skills across the following areas:

ACADEMIC AREAS

- **Mathematics**
- **Keywords** – Vocabulary Building
- **Languages** – Nigerian and Foreign Languages
- **Reasoning** – Quantitative, Verbal, and Non-Verbal
- **English Studies**
- **Social Studies**
- **ICT** – Computer Skills

- **Home Economics**
- **Science** – Agricultural and Basic Science
- **Civic Education**
- **Physical and Emotional Health Education**

SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

We place strong emphasis on developing the whole child through the following skills and attributes:

- **Music**
- **Emotional Intelligence**
- **Writing Skills**
- **Critical-Thinking Skills**
- **Problem-Solving Skills**
- **Research Skills**
- **Creativity Skills**
- **Communication Skills**
- **Collaboration Skills**
- **Conflict-Resolution Skills**
- **Empathy**
- **Flexibility**
- **Responsibility**
- **Respect**
- **Honesty**
- **Gratitude**
- **Basic Speaking Skills**
- **Basic Social Skills**
- **Time-Management Skills**
- **Organisational Skills**
- **Reading and Listening Skills**
- **Speaking Skills**
- **Focus and Concentration Skills**
- **Memory Skills**
- **Leadership Skills**

Our Commitment

At Cuddles Childminders and Schools, we aim to provide more than academic instruction. Our goal is to **develop confident, capable, responsible, creative, and compassionate learners** who are equipped with the knowledge, skills, values, and mindset required to navigate school, family, society, and the wider world successfully.

5.0 RESUMPTION & CLOSING SCHEDULE

CLASS	RESUMPTION	CLOSING	FLEXIBILITY
CRECHE, PLAYGROUP & RECEPTION	7:30- 8:00AM	3:00 – 5:00PM	Parent can pick up from 3pm.
PRE-NUR to NUR III	7:30 -8:00AM	3:15pm	Rigid closing time
BEL 1- BEL 4	7:30AM	3:15PM	Rigid closing time
BEL 5- BEL 6	7:30AM	3:15PM (regular days) 5:15PM (extra lesson days)	Rigid closing times

Club days will apply as scheduled.

5.1. CHILD’S DISPOSITION UPON RESUMPTION & CLOSING

- Your child must be awake, alert, and conscious prior to being received at the school gate. No sleeping child will be received upon arrival at the gate until he/she is fully conscious and actively participatory.
- Your child must be awake, alert, and conscious prior to discharge at the school gate. All children must be fully alert, conscious, and actively participatory upon discharge from the school gate.
- Your child must be neatly dressed in the approved school uniform or appropriate attire for each day, except on special days such as birthday celebrations (applicable only to Primary School students). Any child whose mode of dressing contravenes the school’s dress code will not be received for transportation by the school bus or at the gate during parental drop-off.

6.0. OPEN DOOR POLICY

You are invited and welcome to visit the school at any time while your child/children is/are present, provided that a prior appointment has been made.

Parents and guardians are encouraged to avoid visiting during nap/quiet time (11:30 a.m. to 1:00 p.m. for Crèche, Playgroup, and Reception Classes) as much as possible, in order to minimise disruption to the children’s rest.

Parents of learners from Pre-Nursery to JSS 3 are free to call the school at any time during school hours to enquire about the welfare of their children.

6.1. SOCIAL MEDIA POLICY

At **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)**, our school community uses social media platforms to connect with prospective families, current families, students, and alumni. These platforms may be used to share promotional materials, educational content, school activities, and other relevant information.

The social media platforms used by the school include, but are not limited to, WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook, and Twitter/X.

Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall) takes social media use seriously. Staff, students, and parents are expected to demonstrate respect and to take the privacy and confidentiality of others into careful consideration at all times.

6.1.1. Privacy Protection

To ensure the safety and privacy of our school community, **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** will not post or release information considered private or confidential without appropriate consent. This includes conversations, names, personal schedules, addresses, telephone numbers, and other personal information.

Photographs or videos of students will not be posted on **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** social media accounts if a parent/guardian has specifically opted their child(ren) out of such communications. Unless a parent/guardian has formally opted their child(ren) out, students are considered to have opted in to the school's approved social media communications.

Students, staff, and parents are similarly expected to respect one another's confidential information, as well as the brand, intellectual property, and copyrighted materials of **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)**.

6.1.2. Responding to Comments

Whether comments are positive or negative, it is important that **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** respond appropriately to comments and enquiries made on its social media platforms.

Responses to comments, enquiries, or questions from members of the school community will be handled by the Public Image Officer or another designated member of the school's management team.

6.1.3. Posting During a Crisis

During a crisis or emergency involving the school, parents and members of the school community are strongly discouraged from using social media to issue statements or express opinions on behalf of the school.

Posting personal statements or opinions regarding a school-related incident may conflict with school policy or established communication procedures.

Where necessary, a formal press release will be prepared by the Public Image Team. Depending on the nature of the situation, an official social media statement may also be issued by the Public Image Team.

6.1.4. Expectations for Students

As a student of **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)**, you are welcome to participate appropriately in online interactions involving the school.

Students are expected to demonstrate responsible and respectful behaviour online. Disrespect towards the school, staff, or fellow students, as well as posting photographs or other personal information about other students without appropriate consent, may result in disciplinary action.

7.0. BEHAVIOUR AND DISCIPLINE

No corporal punishment will be used, except where otherwise expressly adopted or agreed upon by the parent and teacher in accordance with the school's approved disciplinary procedures.

Children will be treated with courtesy, respect, patience, and dignity at all times.

Discipline will be administered according to the child's age, developmental stage, and level of understanding. Older children may be given time-out depending on the severity and nature of the offence. No child will, however, be left unattended during a disciplinary intervention.

For grievous contraventions, as outlined in the Students' Rules and Regulations document, expulsion from **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** represents the highest level of disciplinary action. Such action may be immediate or may follow a series of documented interventions, depending on the circumstances.

8.0. NAPTIME

All children are required to have a designated nap/rest period. No child will be forced to sleep; however, children are expected to remain quiet and settled during the designated rest period.

Parents are kindly requested not to schedule pick-ups, drop-offs, or visits during this period, as much as possible, in order to minimise disturbance to children who are resting.

All children in Crèche, Playgroup, and Reception will be provided with clean, separate bedding. Bedding will be washed weekly.

Learners in classes above Pre-Nursery are not routinely provided with nap time, except in cases where a child is visibly fatigued and requires a period of rest.

Where a child becomes fatigued due to an obvious reason, such as excessive physical activity or play, he/she may be allowed time to rest or nap.

Where fatigue occurs without an obvious reason, the child will receive appropriate first aid/initial care, and the parent(s)/guardian(s) will be contacted to pick up the child if necessary.

8.1. POTTY & TOILET TRAINING

(Crèche, Playgroup & Reception)

We will assist with potty/toilet training for children aged two (2) years and above, with the understanding that successful toilet training requires consistent cooperation between the school and the child's parent(s)/guardian(s).

Parents are required to provide underwear or pull-ups for their child as appropriate.

During the potty/toilet training period, parents should provide easy-to-put-on and easy-to-remove clothing until the child is able to independently undress and redress him/herself.

At least two (2) complete changes of clothing are required during the potty-training period.

Parents are also required to provide plastic bags for storing soiled clothing.

9.0. TOILETS/BATHROOMS & TOILET/BATHROOM USAGE

Our toilets and bathrooms are operated in accordance with the school's designated gender-specific arrangements.

Toilets and bathrooms labelled or marked for male use are designated for persons of the male gender.

Toilets and bathrooms labelled or marked for female use are designated for persons of the female gender.

The school does not currently have separate facilities designated for individuals who identify outside the male/female categories. Parents and guardians are encouraged to contact the school management should they have specific concerns regarding toilet or bathroom arrangements for their child.

9.1. MEALS/SNACKS

Nutritionally balanced meals and snacks are to be provided by parents/guardians unless otherwise stated in the school's meal programme.

Children will be offered food and encouraged to eat; however, no child will be force-fed.

Snacks sent to school for each day should consist of healthy options such as fruits, vegetables, nuts, milk, or yoghurt. The specific requirements will depend on the school's termly Healthy Snack Plan.

Please do not send:

- Expired food or drinks.
- Food containing bones that may pose a choking hazard.
- Overly spiced food.

For children in the Crèche, Playgroup, and Reception Classes, mild-food preparation options, such as preparing morsel meals and warming soup, are available.

Please note that any food brought from home outside the approved preparation options, other than the powder required for morsel meals, will be rejected and will not be prepared by the school.

Parents are required to provide portable drinking water for their children. If the water supplied from home runs out, the school will refill the child's bottle from its trusted water source, certified by Impact Water.

For older children in Nursery and Primary, only food warming is available, and this is subject to the availability of electricity. Parents are therefore encouraged to keep children's meals in insulated food containers/carriers.

Parents are encouraged to ensure that their children arrive at the Crèche/school at appropriate times to receive their meals or have eaten adequately at home before arrival.

Children are encouraged to use mealtimes as opportunities to share their experiences and interact appropriately with one another.

Manners and appropriate mealtime etiquette will also be taught and encouraged. Children aged two (2) years and above will be encouraged to self-feed.

From time to time, advice will be offered to parents regarding each child's feeding routine and ways to improve feeding and meal preparation. This service is limited to Crèche and Reception pupils.

Please note that food supplies for Crèche and Reception pupils may be brought in daily or weekly.

However, we advise parents to allow the school to establish a trusted relationship with the child before commencing weekly food supplies.

10.0. SUPPLIES

(Crèche & Playgroup)

Each child will have a designated space for his/her personal belongings. Parents are requested to clearly label all items belonging to their child.

Please provide the following items for your child:

- Two (2) or three (3) complete changes of clothing, including shirts, trousers/shorts/skirts, underwear, diapers where applicable, and socks. Please ensure that all clothing is appropriate for the weather and season.
- Four (4) to five (5) diapers for children under two (2) years of age.
- Bum-shield/barrier cream or oil and hair oil, where applicable.
- Wipes for children under one (1) year of age.

10.1. CLOTHING

(Crèche & Playgroup)

Children should wear clothing that provides comfort and convenience. For the child's safety, please do not send children to school in clogs, flip-flops, oversized clothing, or other unsuitable footwear or clothing.

Children should always be dressed appropriately for the weather.

Parents are required to provide two (2) to three (3) complete changes of clothing every day, as appropriate for the weather.

We will do our best to take care of each child's belongings. However, accidents do happen, and the childcare/school will not be held responsible for lost, damaged, or soiled clothing.

Pupils in the Nursery Section are required to wear the approved school uniform at all times. Therefore, additional changes of clothing are not required unless specifically requested by the school.

11.0. SAFETY

Our childcare and school environment is structured to provide a safe and secure environment for children. We have established emergency and fire procedures, and practice drills are conducted regularly.

We are committed to the safety and wellbeing of your child whenever he/she is in our care.

To support this commitment, video surveillance cameras are installed throughout the school premises to monitor the school environment and support the safety and security of staff, pupils, and visitors.

Parents are requested not to send toys, sweets/candy, chewing gum, or money with their child unless specifically requested by the school.

These items may place an unnecessary burden on staff and may cause distress when they are removed. Some of these items may also present choking or other safety hazards if staff are unaware that they are in the child's possession.

Although children are supervised at all times, staff cannot be physically beside a child every second to prevent every fall, trip, bump, or minor accident.

If a child sustains a non-life-threatening injury, the child will be assessed and appropriate basic first aid will be provided.

In the event of a serious injury or medical emergency, the parent(s)/guardian(s) will be notified immediately, and appropriate steps will be taken to obtain medical assistance.

For emergency purposes, **PARENTS MUST KEEP ALL CONTACT NUMBERS CURRENT.**

If we are unable to reach the parent/guardian through the contact information provided, we will administer appropriate first aid and, where necessary, transport the child to his/her doctor or to Vinnette Hospital, taking proximity and the circumstances of the emergency into consideration.

11.1. WEATHER & CLOTHING

Parents are responsible for ensuring that children are dressed appropriately for the prevailing weather conditions.

11.2. FIRE SAFETY

Fire extinguishers are located throughout the school premises.

If a fire cannot be extinguished quickly and safely, the children will be evacuated immediately in accordance with the school's emergency evacuation procedure.

12.0. TELEVISION

Children may be permitted to have supervised television/video viewing time to watch age-appropriate programmes on cable television.

Parents who have objections to their child participating in television/video viewing should notify the school.

We will respect and endeavour to honour parents' reasonable preferences regarding television viewing.

13.0. DROP-OFF/PICK-UP

Please do not leave your vehicle running while dropping off or picking up your child.

Your child must leave the school environment in the company of the authorised parent/guardian or designated pick-up person.

Please do not allow your child to play near vehicles at any time.

The school assumes responsibility for your child only while he/she is in our care during the school's regular operating hours.

No child will be permitted to leave the school with anyone other than a parent/guardian or a person listed on the authorised alternative pick-up list without written permission from the parent/guardian.

Telephone permission will not be accepted.

Any person unfamiliar to the school will be required to provide valid identification before a child is released into his/her care. Parents are expected to inform any authorised alternative pick-up person of these requirements in advance.

If the person arriving to pick up a child appears unwell or appears to be under the influence of alcohol or any other substance that may impair his/her ability to safely care for the child, another authorised person will be contacted to pick up the child.

14.0. COURT ORDERS AND FAMILY DISAGREEMENTS

In cases of family disputes affecting the custody of a child, **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** will recognise a valid court order or injunction specifying who has legal custody of the child as the primary legal document governing the child's release from school.

Where a court order or injunction is in process and has not yet been formally communicated to the school by the relevant court or authority, a detailed mutual agreement signed by both parents involved in the custody dispute may serve as an interim document for the school's consideration.

The agreement must clearly state the agreed custody and pick-up arrangements and must be sufficiently detailed and unambiguous.

15.0. CHILD ABUSE

(ALL FORMS OF ABUSE)

Where there are reasonable grounds to believe that a child is being abused by one or both parents/guardians, and signs or symptoms of abuse are observed or become apparent within the school environment, **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** will take appropriate safeguarding action.

Where necessary, the matter may be reported to the appropriate child protection, law enforcement, or statutory authorities in accordance with applicable Nigerian law and child safeguarding procedures.

The school may seek guidance or intervention from relevant child protection organisations, including the Cece Yara Foundation, where appropriate.

16.0. GIFTS TO STAFF MEMBERS

It should be noted that it is **AGAINST SCHOOL POLICY** for gifts, whether in cash or kind, to be offered to any member of staff.

This policy is intended to promote fairness, transparency, and equal treatment of all learners and to prevent any situation that may create an actual or perceived conflict of interest.

17.0. HOME LESSONS

It is strictly forbidden for a parent/guardian to employ any teacher or staff member of **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** as a private/home tutor for his/her child while the child remains a learner in the school.

Any staff member who solicits, lobbies for, or accepts such a private tutoring arrangement should be reported to the school management.

18.0. TRANSPORTATION

A school bus service is available to interested families.

The current bus schedule is as follows:

- **7:00 a.m.:** Pick-up time
- **3:00 p.m.:** First drop-off period
- **4:30 p.m.:** Second drop-off period

Parents are expected to ensure that children are ready and available at the designated pick-up point at the scheduled time.

19.0. DAYS AND HOURS OF OPERATION

Crèche, Playgroup & Reception

7:00 a.m. – 5:30 p.m. daily

Pre-Nursery

7:30 a.m. – 3:00 p.m. daily

Nursery 1 & 2

7:30 a.m. – 3:00 p.m. daily

Please note that after-school care services are available at an additional cost to parents who may be interested.

Parents are advised to strictly adhere to the applicable closing time.

An hourly late pick-up fee of **₦1,000.00** will commence after a twenty-minute grace period.

Please note that calling to inform the school of a late pick-up does not waive the late pick-up fee. The applicable fee will still stand.

20.0. HOLIDAYS AND BIRTHDAYS

We observe all public holidays and recognise the birthdays of all children.

Please note that birthday celebrations held at the school should be kept as simple as possible and should comply with the school's established guidelines.

The Crèche will be closed on weekends, all public holidays, and from **21 December to 8 January** to cover the Christmas and New Year holiday period. This may, however, be subject to government directives or other official announcements.

In addition, all childminders are entitled to one to two weeks (five to ten working days) of annual vacation. Childminders will take their vacation at alternate times, depending on class requirements, so that two childminders serving the same class are not away at the same time.

At least thirty (30) days' notice will be provided prior to scheduled vacation periods, except in cases of emergencies or illness.

21.0. SCHOOL FEES

Please note that all fees must be paid no later than the first day/week of the applicable fee period, as stipulated by the school.

The pupil's name should be clearly indicated as the payee/reference on bank tellers or other payment documentation.

Fees for the Pre-Nursery and Nursery Sections will be made available upon resumption.

22.0. SICK CHILD AND MEDICATION POLICIES

At **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)**, we have established guidelines to help prevent children from contracting and spreading viral, bacterial, and other communicable illnesses.

By following these guidelines strictly, we can collectively reduce unnecessary exposure and help minimise the number of sick days experienced by children and their families.

BUT WE MUST ALL WORK TOGETHER.

Parents/guardians will be expected to come and pick up their child **promptly** if he/she develops one or more of the following symptoms:

1. A temperature above **38.0°C** or below **32.0°C**.
2. Vomiting more than once.
3. More than two diarrhoea stools.
4. Any signs of chickenpox, measles, or other communicable diseases.
5. Two or more of the following: profuse nasal discharge, coloured nasal discharge, barking/croupy cough.
6. Skin rashes in any area other than the diaper area.
7. Cold sores that are open and draining, or impetigo.
8. Any child who is visibly ill or appears to be in pain.
9. Pink eye (conjunctivitis).

Please note that any child presenting with one or more of the above symptoms, as well as any child with **burns of any degree**, should **NOT** be brought to the Crèche/school and should receive appropriate treatment and be certified fit before returning.

Parents/guardians will be notified of any accidents that occur while the child is in the school's care.

The management team will also notify parents when a child is due for immunisation and/or routine physical examinations, where applicable to Crèche and Reception pupils.

Pupils of **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** may be required, at the discretion of management, to undergo physical examinations at a reputable medical facility, such as Federal Staff Hospital, Abuja.

Such physical/medical examinations may include assessments or enquiries relating to the child's weight, height, and basic physical areas such as the mouth, chest, ears, throat, head, abdomen, and other relevant areas.

New pupils may also be required to undergo a chest X-ray where considered necessary. Please note that genotype and blood group information are required for every child.

All physical examination and immunisation records must be submitted alongside the registration form upon enrolment.

22.1. RETURNING TO SCHOOL AFTER ILLNESS

When returning to school after an illness:

1. The child must be free from fever without the use of paracetamol or any other analgesic/fever-reducing medication.

2. A child who has been prescribed antibiotics must have taken the medication for at least twenty-four (24) hours before returning to school and must be symptom-free, except where otherwise medically advised for conditions such as an ear infection.
3. Prescription medication must be properly labelled by the pharmacy/drug store and must clearly bear the child's name, medication date, and dosage instructions. Medication that is to be administered at school must be recorded in the medication section of the communication book by the parent/guardian and duly signed. Please note that failure to provide the required information may result in the medication not being administered.
4. Unless a physician provides a written note specifically restricting outdoor activity, all children are expected to participate in outdoor activities on designated days, provided that weather conditions are favourable.

If a child is absent for an extended period of more than one week (five school days) due to illness, a doctor's certificate/medical clearance confirming fitness to return to school may be required upon the child's return.

Parents are encouraged to carefully schedule medication for children in the Nursery Section so that, where possible, medication does not need to be administered during school hours.

We will do our best to maintain a healthy environment for all children. However, no environment can be completely germ-free. Reducing exposure and maintaining good hygiene can help minimise the harmful effects of germs.

One of the most effective ways to reduce the spread of germs is through thorough and frequent handwashing.

We will follow applicable handwashing, cleaning, and equipment sanitation requirements in accordance with the relevant FCT licensing standards for daycare centres and schools.

Children will be encouraged to wash their hands frequently, particularly before eating and after using the toilet.

23.0. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We hope these guidelines clarify the policies and procedures of **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** and help us work together to protect the health, safety, wellbeing, and development of every child entrusted to our care.

24.0. HEALTH HISTORY, CONTRACT & PARENTAL ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

HEALTH HISTORY FORM

NOTE: The Health History Form must be completed truthfully, accurately, and in full. Parents/guardians are responsible for ensuring that all information provided is current and complete.

Please kindly inform the school promptly of any lateness or absence. Waiting for children to arrive affects our schedules and the smooth operation of the school.

25.0. CHILDCARE SERVICES CONTRACT

All childcare services provided by **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** are subject to a formal contract.

The contract is a legally binding document that obligates **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** to provide the agreed childcare services and obligates the parent(s)/guardian(s) to make the required payments for those services.

The contract contains other requirements, terms, and conditions. Parents/guardians are strongly encouraged to read the contract thoroughly, ensure that they understand its provisions, and seek clarification on any aspect they do not understand before signing.

By signing the contract, the parent(s)/guardian(s) acknowledge that they have read, understood, and accepted its terms and conditions and agree to be bound by them.

26.0. TRIAL PERIOD

There will be a **two-week paid trial period** for all children enrolling in the Crèche.

During the two-week trial period, either **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** or the child's parent(s)/guardian(s) may terminate the childcare arrangement if either party determines that there are reasonable grounds for doing so.

Termination during the trial period may be effected without the requirement for prior notice.

The trial period must be paid for in full by the parent(s)/guardian(s) before the child is accepted into the class.

27.0. TERMINATION OF CHILDCARE SERVICES

If **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** determines that the requirements of the childcare contract are not being met, or if circumstances arise that create a significant conflict or difficulty in providing appropriate care for a child, the school reserves the right to terminate the childcare contract.

Where termination is initiated by the school, the family will ordinarily be given a minimum of **two (2) weeks' notice**, except where the circumstances warrant immediate termination in accordance with the terms of the contract or applicable school policy.

Where possible, the school will provide reasonable assistance to the family during the transition.

The school reserves the right to terminate childcare services where:

1. Immunisation and/or required physical or medical check-up requirements are not met.
2. Tuition or other required fees are not paid in full within the stipulated period.
3. The parent(s)/guardian(s) consistently fail to support or comply with the school's policies and procedures.
4. The parent(s)/guardian(s) demonstrate significant negligence in matters affecting the child's welfare, safety, attendance, or care.
5. A parent/guardian treats any member of staff or representative of **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** in an abusive, threatening, disrespectful, or derogatory manner.
6. The child is unable to adjust satisfactorily to the childcare/school environment despite reasonable support and intervention.
7. The child's behaviour is persistently disruptive, unmanageable, or harmful to other children, childminders, teachers, staff members, or the child him/herself.

28.0. CONFIDENTIALITY

Information supplied by parents/guardians to **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** will be treated as confidential and handled with appropriate care.

We will respect the privacy of families and will not disclose confidential information to external persons without appropriate authorisation.

Before information is released to an external individual or organisation, the parent(s)/guardian(s) will ordinarily be required to provide written consent through a release form.

This requirement does not apply where disclosure is required or permitted by law, including disclosures to law enforcement, child protection authorities, regulatory bodies, courts, or other legally authorised agencies.

29.0. COMMUNICATION

The purpose of these policies is to minimise misunderstandings and provide parents/guardians with a clear understanding of the expectations of **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)** and the expectations that parents/guardians may reasonably have of the school.

We believe that open, respectful, and timely communication between parents/guardians and the school is essential to ensuring that every child receives the best possible care, support, and educational experience.

If a parent/guardian has any question, concern, or difficulty concerning any part of this policy or the childcare contract, we encourage them to communicate with the Head of School or designated school administrator as soon as possible.

Parents/guardians are encouraged to raise concerns promptly rather than allowing them to develop into misunderstandings or unresolved issues.

These policies may be reviewed, amended, or updated from time to time to reflect changes in school operations, applicable regulations, or the needs of the school community.

30.0. LIMITATION OF LIABILITY

Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall) shall not be held liable for loss, injury, damage, or other consequences arising from a parent's/guardian's breach of any provision of this policy, the childcare contract, or other applicable school rules and procedures, except where such liability cannot lawfully be excluded or limited.

Parents/guardians are expected to familiarise themselves with and comply with all applicable policies, procedures, rules, and contractual obligations.



31.0. PARENTAL ACKNOWLEDGEMENT AND ACCEPTANCE

By signing below, the parent(s)/guardian(s) confirm that they have read, understood, and agreed to abide by the provisions of this policy and the applicable childcare contract of **Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)**.

The parent(s)/guardian(s) further acknowledge that they have had the opportunity to ask questions and seek clarification regarding any provision they do not understand.

PARENT/GUARDIAN DETAILS

Name of Parent/Guardian 1:

.....

Name of Parent/Guardian 2:

.....

Residential Address:

.....
.....

Occupational Address:

.....
.....

Date:

.....

Signature of Parent/Guardian 1:

.....

Signature of Parent/Guardian 2:

.....



HEALTH HISTORY FORM

CHILD'S INFORMATION

Child's Name: _____

Date of Birth: _____

Child's Weight at Birth: _____

HEALTH HISTORY

Please answer all questions truthfully and accurately. Where applicable, provide additional details in the spaces provided.

1. General Health

Does this child appear to be well most of the time?

☐ Yes ☐ No

2. Current Medication

Is the child currently taking any medication?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, please state the name of the medication, reason for use, dosage, and frequency:

3. Ear Infections

Has this child had as many as three (3) episodes of ear trouble/infection within the past year?

☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

If yes, please provide details:

4. Colds or Sore Throat Infections

Has this child usually had more than three (3) colds or sore throat infections accompanied by fever within the past year?

☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

If yes, please provide details:

5. Eyes and Vision

Has this child ever experienced problems with his/her eyes or vision?

☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

If yes, please provide details:

6. Unusual Chewing or Eating Habits

Does your child chew or eat unusual items such as pencils, crib rails, window ledges, paint chips, plaster, hair, or other non-food items?

☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

If yes, please provide details:

7. Disability, Developmental, or Special Support Needs

Does your child have any disability, developmental condition, special educational need, or other condition that the school/childcare staff should be aware of?

☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

If yes, please specify:

8. Other Illnesses or Medical Conditions

Has this child ever had any other significant illness, disease, or medical condition not mentioned above?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, please specify:

9. Hospitalisation

Has this child ever been hospitalised?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, please state the reason, date/period, and outcome:

10. Serious Accident or Poisoning

Has this child ever experienced a serious accident, injury, or poisoning?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, please state the type of accident/injury or poisoning, when it occurred, and how it was treated:

11. Medical Specialist

Has this child ever been seen or treated by a medical specialist?

☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

If yes:

Name/Type of Specialist: _____

Reason for Consultation: _____

Treatment/Outcome: _____

12. MEDICAL AND BIRTH HISTORY

Please tick **all** conditions that apply to your child:

☐ Premature birth

☐ Trouble breathing

☐ Head injury

☐ Birth injury

☐ Birth defect

☐ Other birth-related condition

If applicable, please specify:

ALLERGIES AND RELATED CONDITIONS

Please tick any that apply:

☐ Eczema

☐ Hives

☐ Wheezing

- ☐ Asthma
- ☐ Insect-sting allergy/reaction
- ☐ Food allergy
- ☐ Medication allergy
- ☐ Other allergic reaction
- ☐ Convulsions
- ☐ Seizures
- ☐ Other:

PLEASE PROVIDE ADDITIONAL INFORMATION WHERE APPLICABLE

Parent/Guardian's Name: _____

Relationship to Child: _____

Parent/Guardian's Signature: _____

Date: _____